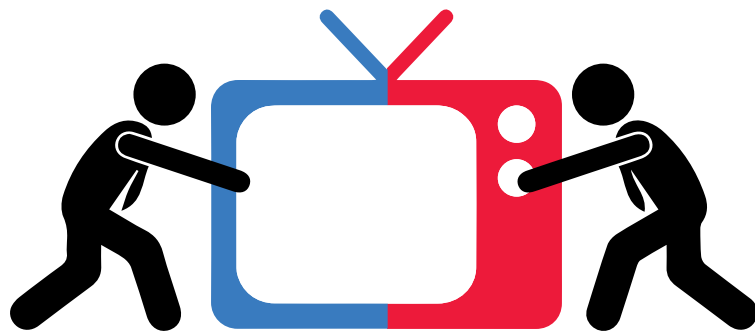
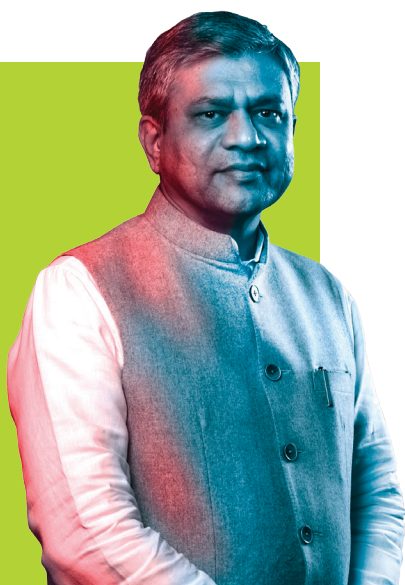


MAN OF THE MOMENT

Ashwini Vaishnaw, who holds charge of three important Cabinet ministries—Minister for Railways, Communications, Electronics & Information Technology—will spearhead many decisions and policies in 2023, including telecom bills and data protection. The man who wears many hats remains the man of the moment.



THE MERGER REPORT

HOW WILL THE big media mergers play out this year? As one awaits the completion of the Zee-Sony and PVR-Innox marriages, the impact of both on broadcasting and exhibition will be felt. More importantly, will cultural integration and the process of ensuring it is business as usual play out?

RUPEE ON THE RADAR

ON THE BACK OF rising crude oil prices the rupee depreciated by more than 10 per cent in 2022. With crude oil prices trending lower than the highs of 2022 and interest rate hikes expected to slow down in the US, the rupee will be on the radar of policymakers as it plays an important role in setting policy.



Heir not so Apparent

AS UDAY KOTAK, the Founder, MD & CEO of Kotak Mahindra Bank, hangs up his boots at the end of his term in December 2023, all eyes will be on his successor. The bank's top management team is not getting any younger and the new leader, whether an insider or outsider, will have giant-sized shoes to fill. The Reserve Bank of India has recently capped the tenure of a bank's CEO at 15 years, whereas Kotak has been at the helm of affairs for over 18 years.



CHANDRA'S CHALLENGES

N. Chandrasekaran, the Tata Sons boss, will have his hands full in 2023 with making Tata Neu click and ensuring the newly-merged Air India-Vistara entity takes off. Speaking of digital, Neu is up against the likes of Amazon, Flipkart and Jio. It's faced teething troubles and has a lot of room for improvement. In aviation, the larger Air India entity needs to figure out how to reduce losses, strengthen its fleet and continuously up the service quotient.